

Chat filter blocks ordinary words

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The filter searches for each banned word **anywhere in a message, including inside longer words**, and the word list is **mostly Brazilian Portuguese**. Its short entries are applied to all eight languages the game ships in, so the filter blocks ordinary words in every one of them.

THE SHORTEST DEMONSTRATION

a player types **thank** → **the message is delivered**
a player types **thanks** → **the message is blocked**
adding one letter creates ks, which is on the word list

THE RULE IS TWO CHARACTERS, MATCHED ANYWHERE

cu	blocked	xxcuxx	blocked	xxcxx	ok	xxuxx	ok	xxucxx	ok
ks	blocked	xxksxx	blocked	xxkxx	ok	xxsxx	ok	xxskxx	ok

The filter blocks these letters on their own, and again inside a made-up word, at any position. It delivers each letter on its own, and delivers the same two letters reversed. The filter delivered **10,627 words** during this audit, and none of them contains cu or ks.

CONFIRMED RULES AND ORDINARY WORDS AFFECTED

RULE	WORDS	ORDINARY WORDS CENSORED
cu	5,016	document, discuss, security, focus, circus
nb	956	number, inbox, unbind
meter	695	parameter, diameter, kilometer
anta	419	advantage, santa, fantastic
ks	408	thanks, tasks, books, works, weeks
pus	230	campus, octopus, push
pica	227	typical, tropical
puta	95	reputation, computation

8,414 distinct ordinary English words, 3.6% of the language

DELIVERED UNDER THE SAME TEST

bitch	ok	rape	ok		
sex	ok	slut	ok	whore	ok

All 27 Portuguese terms tested are blocked, including *arrombado* and *otario*. The filter is not over-aggressive in general — it is aggressive about one language's vocabulary and largely absent for another's. One root cause: a term list never reviewed against the locales it is applied to.

THREE WAYS TO FIX IT, IN INCREASING EFFORT

- 1 Allow the confirmed words.** `findings/words-to-allow.txt` lists **343 ordinary words** confirmed blocked, each annotated with the rule responsible. If the filter already supports an exception list, this is a data change and nothing else — it removes false positives only.
- 2 Require a word boundary for short terms.** One rule — *entries shorter than five characters match only as whole words* — removes most of the problem. The filter still blocks a message that is only the word `cu`, and stops blocking `document`. Entries of five characters or more are not affected.
- 3 Replace the matcher.** `engine/` — per-term match modes, severity tiers, exception-list rescue, evasion folding. No dependencies, MIT, 55 tests and 29 conformance vectors, at the same `check(text)` seam as today's filter.

Content notice. This audit concerns a profanity filter; the terms quoted above appear as evidence.

15,307 messages sent through the ordinary game client into a private party channel; no client modification, no server access. **343 ordinary words confirmed blocked, 10,627 confirmed delivered.** Every entry was tested inside a made-up word before being reported, and every finding needed two separate tests. Our own measured error rate is 1.2% per test. Logs: `findings/raw-logs/`.